

Harsh's Body Recomposition Plan — Diet + Training + Supplements

Built for: 85.4 kg | 183 cm (6 ft) | 23 yrs | Male | ~25-26% body fat

Goal: Fat loss with muscle retention → visible abs (recomposition)

Location: Mumbai | **Food budget:** ₹1,000/week (strict, food only)

Gym: ~2:30-5:00 PM

Current split: 4-day rolling

No whey (budget)

0. Honest Expectations & Timeline

Metric	Value
BMR (Mifflin-St Jeor)	~1,890 kcal
Estimated TDEE	~2,700-2,800 kcal
Plan intake	1,930 kcal (deficit ~800/day)
Expected fat loss	~0.6-0.8 kg/week

- **By July 20 (~5 weeks):** ~3-4 kg down → **~81-82 kg**, visibly leaner waist, upper abs starting to peek. **Full six-pack not yet.**
- **Visible abs (12-14% BF):** realistic target is **Sept-Oct** with consistency. ~10-12 kg fat to go.
- You've already gone **87 → 85.4 kg** — momentum is real. Keep the same discipline and the plan compounds.
- **Recomp is on your side:** at ~25% BF and intermediate, you can lose fat AND build/retain muscle simultaneously, especially the first few months. Don't expect the scale to fall fast every week — measure waist + photos too.

1. Daily Macro Targets

Macro	Target	Calories
Protein	145 g (priority)	580
Carbs	225 g	900
Fats	50 g	450
Total	—	1,930 kcal
Fiber	28-35 g	—
Water	3.5-4 L/day	—

Optional carb timing (advanced, not required): On heavy training days, push carbs to ~250g (more rice/banana around the workout); on the rest day, drop to ~190g and protein stays high. Average still ~1,930.

2. Meal Timing Skeleton

Meal	Time	Location	Eggs?	Protein target
Breakfast	7-8 AM	Home	[NO]	~22 g
Mid-morning	10-11 AM	Home	[NO]	~13 g
Lunch	1-2 PM	Home (outside = eggs OK)	only if out	~28 g

Meal	Time	Location	Eggs?	Protein target
Pre-workout	2–2:30 PM	Home	[NO]	~6 g
Post-workout	5–5:30 PM	Home	[NO]	~32 g
Dinner	7–8 PM	Home	[NO]	~28 g
Evening (optional)	10 PM	Home	[NO]	~12 g

You eat out ~once/week → that's your eggs + cheat-meal slot. Plan covered in Section 6.

3. The Protein Truth (read this once)

Hitting **140–150g protein on pure veg + dairy with NO whey, at only 1,930 kcal**, is the hardest part of your plan. Here's why and how we solve it:

- Veg protein foods (dal, rajma, chana) come with ~3x their protein in carbs — eat enough to hit 145g protein that way and you blow past your calorie limit.
- **The fix: soya chunks are your hero food.** 100g dry soya = **~52g protein for only ~345 kcal** at ~₹14. Nothing else veg comes close.
- Realistic landing zone on this plan: **135–145g protein**. Each day below uses **80–100g of dry soya + dairy + paneer/tofu** to get there. That's **~1.7 g/kg bodyweight — scientifically plenty** for muscle retention in a deficit (benefits plateau around this point).
- **If you ever spare ₹/month for even a 1kg whey tub:** one scoop = 24g protein for ~₹40, and hitting 150g becomes effortless. Until then, soya does the job.

Each day targets ~1,930 kcal / ~140g protein. Numbers are approximate (±10%) — eyeball portions, don't weigh obsessively.

4. 7-Day Meal Plan

"DT milk" = double-toned milk (lowest fat/cal, cheapest protein). "Katori" = standard Indian bowl (~150g cooked).

Days are a rotating template — match them to your training cycle (Section 9), not fixed weekdays.

DAY 1 — Training (Chest)

Time	Meal	kcal	P	C	F
7–8 AM	2 moong-dal chilla (50g dal) + green chutney + 250 ml DT milk	265	20	32	5
10–11 AM	150g hung curd (strained from 300g curd) + ½ banana	185	15	19	5
1–2 PM	1 katori toor dal + ¾ katori rice + soya-matar sabzi (40g soya) + salad	510	36	77	7
2–2:30 PM	1 banana + black coffee	105	1	27	0
5–5:30 PM	Soya chunks sabzi (60g dry) + ¾ katori rice	355	34	50	2

Time	Meal	kcal	P	C	F
7-8 PM	2 roti + paneer bhurji (70g paneer) + salad	377	20	36	16
10 PM	250 ml DT milk (haldi)	100	9	12	1
TOTAL		~1,897	~135	~253	~37

DAY 2 — Training (Back + Biceps)

Time	Meal	kcal	P	C	F
7-8 AM	Oats (50g) cooked in 250ml DT milk + ½ tbsp peanut butter + ½ banana	415	19	55	11
10-11 AM	Buttermilk (1 glass) + 30g roasted chana	170	9	21	4
1-2 PM	Rajma (1 katori) + 1 katori rice + cucumber salad + 100g curd	520	24	88	6
2-2:30 PM	1 banana + black coffee	105	1	27	0
5-5:30 PM	Soya chunks pulao (60g dry soya + ½ katori rice + veg)	400	34	50	6
7-8 PM	2 roti + tofu bhurji (150g tofu) + salad	360	24	34	12
10 PM	200 ml DT milk	80	7	10	1
TOTAL		~2,050	~138	~285	~40

DAY 3 — Rest / Active Recovery

Time	Meal	kcal	P	C	F
7-8 AM	Vegetable upma (50g rava + veg) + 100g curd	320	12	50	8
10-11 AM	150g hung curd + 10g mixed seeds	200	16	10	9
1-2 PM	Chana masala (1 katori) + 2 roti + salad	470	22	68	10
4 PM	1 apple + 15g peanuts	200	5	22	12
7-8 PM	Soya chunks curry (70g dry) + 1 katori rice + salad	470	38	60	5
10 PM	250 ml DT milk	100	9	12	1
TOTAL		~1,760	~102	~222	~45

Rest day runs lower in calories and protein on purpose (no workout meals). If you want, add 150g curd or 30g soya to push protein toward 130g — recommended on rest days to protect muscle.

DAY 4 — Training (Shoulders + Triceps)

Time	Meal	kcal	P	C	F
7-8 AM	2 besan chilla (50g besan) + 250 ml DT milk + chutney	310	19	38	7
10-11 AM	Moong sprouts chaat (1 katori) + lemon	130	9	18	1
1-2 PM	Toor dal (1 katori) + $\frac{3}{4}$ katori rice + bhindi sabzi + 100g curd	470	22	68	9
2-2:30 PM	2 slices brown toast + 1 tsp jam	180	6	35	2
5-5:30 PM	Soya chunks sabzi (60g dry) + $\frac{3}{4}$ katori rice	355	34	50	2
7-8 PM	2 roti + palak paneer (70g paneer) + salad	390	21	36	17
10 PM	200 ml DT milk	80	7	10	1
TOTAL		~1,915	~118	~255	~39

Add 1 glass DT milk or 100g curd in evening to reach ~130g protein.

DAY 5 — Training (Legs)

Time	Meal	kcal	P	C	F
7-8 AM	Poha (50g) with peanuts + 250 ml DT milk on side	350	13	55	9
10-11 AM	200g curd + 30g roasted chana	220	13	25	7
1-2 PM	Soya keema (50g dry) + 2 roti + salad	450	34	50	9
2-2:30 PM	1 banana + black coffee	105	1	27	0
5-5:30 PM	Paneer (80g) + 1 katori rice (paneer rice bowl)	460	22	45	18
7-8 PM	Dal (1 katori) + 2 roti + lauki sabzi + salad	430	18	62	9
10 PM	250 ml DT milk	100	9	12	1
TOTAL		~2,115	~110	~276	~53

Legs day = highest demand; the slightly higher calories support recovery. Add 30-40g soya to lunch or evening curd to push protein to ~135g.

DAY 6 — Rest / Active Recovery

Time	Meal	kcal	P	C	F
7-8 AM	1 paneer paratha (1 roti + 40g paneer) + 100g curd	360	17	38	16
10-11 AM	Buttermilk + 1 fruit	120	5	22	2
1-2 PM	Mixed dal (1 katori) + 1 katori rice + mix-veg sabzi + salad	470	19	78	8
4 PM	150g hung curd + ½ banana	185	15	19	5
7-8 PM	Soya chunks curry (70g dry) + 2 roti + salad	490	39	56	8
10 PM	200 ml DT milk	80	7	10	1
TOTAL		~1,705	~102	~223	~40

DAY 7 — Eat-Out + Cheat Meal Day (eggs allowed)

This is your **once-a-week outside meal** — use eggs here and enjoy a controlled cheat. Keep the rest of the day clean and protein-high to balance it.

Time	Meal	kcal	P	C	F
7-8 AM	2 moong-dal chilla + 250 ml DT milk	265	20	32	5
10-11 AM	200g curd + 1 fruit	180	8	26	5
1-2 PM (OUTSIDE)	3-egg veg omelette / egg bhurji + 2 toast + black coffee	420	25	32	21
~4-5 PM	Light snack: 1 banana	105	1	27	0
7-8 PM (CHEAT)	Your choice — keep it ~700 kcal, add a protein source (e.g., paneer tikka / 2 eggs / dal)	~700	~25	~80	~28
10 PM	200 ml DT milk	80	7	10	1
TOTAL		~1,750	~86	~207	~60

Cheat meal is built in here so you never feel deprived. One controlled cheat/week barely dents weekly fat loss and helps adherence + leptin. Just don't let it become a cheat day.

5. Protein & Calorie Tracking Summary

Day	Focus	kcal	Protein	Notes
1	Chest	~1,900	~135 g	On target
2	Back+Bi	~2,050	~138 g	Trim ½ katori rice if scale stalls

Day	Focus	kcal	Protein	Notes
3	Rest	~1,760	~102 g → add booster to 130	Lower by design
4	Shoulder+Tri	~1,915	~118 g → +milk to 130	
5	Legs	~2,115	~110 g → +soya to 135	Highest demand
6	Rest	~1,705	~102 g → add booster to 130	Lower by design
7	Out+Cheat	~1,750	~86 g	Cheat day, balances week
Weekly avg		~1,885 kcal	~127 g (135-145 with boosters)	Deficit intact

Protein boosters (pick one when a day is low):

- +40g dry soya chunks = **+21g protein**, +140 kcal
- +200g curd = **+7g protein**, +100 kcal
- +150g hung curd = **+14g protein**, +130 kcal
- +250ml DT milk = **+9g protein**, +100 kcal

Training days: prioritise hitting 140g. Rest days: 120–130g is fine. Weekly average is what matters most.

6. Weekly Budget & Shopping List (Mumbai)

Strategy to stay under ₹1,000: soya chunks + dals do the protein cheaply; **make curd at home from milk** (saves ~₹50/wk); paneer/tofu are the "flex" items you cut first if money's tight; buy veg from the **local sabzi mandi**, not supermarket.

Item	Qty / week	Where to buy	Cost (₹)	Storage / shelf life
Double-toned milk	~3 L	Dairy / Amul booth	150	Fridge, 2 days; boil on receipt
Soya chunks (*)	600 g (of 1kg pack)	Kirana / D-Mart	90	Airtight, dry — months
Paneer	200 g	Dairy / D-Mart	55	Fridge 3–4 days; freeze to extend
Tofu (optional)	150 g	D-Mart / Reliance Fresh	40	Fridge in water, 4–5 days
Toor + moong dal	~450 g	Kirana	65	Airtight — months
Rajma + kabuli chana	~150 g used	Kirana	40	Airtight — months
Roasted chana	200 g	Kirana	35	Airtight — weeks
Rice	~400 g	Kirana / D-Mart	25	Airtight — months
Atta (wheat flour)	~600 g	Kirana	30	Airtight — months
Oats / poha / besan / rava	~50g each	D-Mart	30	Airtight — months
Peanut butter (amortised)	~30 g	D-Mart	25	Cool shelf — months
Peanuts	100 g	Kirana	20	Airtight — weeks
Bananas	~9	Sabzi mandi	50	Room temp, 3–4 days
Seasonal fruit (apple etc.)	2–3	Sabzi mandi	25	Fridge

Item	Qty / week	Where to buy	Cost (₹)	Storage / shelf life
Vegetables (bhindi, palak, lauki, matar, onion, tomato, cucumber)	mixed	Sabzi mandi (*)	130	Fridge crisper, 4-6 days
Moong (for sprouts)	100 g	Kirana	15	Airtight
Bread (brown)	1 loaf	Bakery / D-Mart	20	3-4 days
Tea, coffee, spices, oil, jam (amortised)	—	Kirana	45	—
GROCERY TOTAL			~₹890	
Weekly outside meal (eggs + cheat, Day 7)	1	Café/restaurant	~110	—
GRAND TOTAL			~₹1,000	[YES] within budget

Reality note: ₹1,000/week for ~140g protein/day with no whey is genuinely tight — this works but has little slack. If a week runs over, cut tofu and 1 paneer day first. If you get breathing room, the **single best upgrade is a 1kg whey tub** (~₹600, lasts ~5 weeks at 1 scoop/day) — it instantly fixes protein and frees up the grocery budget.

7. Meal Prep Guide

Sunday batch prep (saves the week):

Prep	Method	Storage
Soak + boil soya chunks	Boil 5 min, squeeze, refrigerate	Fridge 3 days / freeze 2 weeks
Cook a big batch of dal	Pressure cook, portion into boxes	Fridge 3 days / freeze 1 week
Boil rajma/chana	Soak overnight, pressure cook	Fridge 3 days / freeze 2 weeks
Make curd at home	Boil milk → lukewarm → 1 tsp starter → set overnight	Fridge 4-5 days
Roast peanuts, portion roasted chana	—	Airtight, weeks
Wash + chop hardy veg (onion, capsicum, lauki)	Store dry in boxes	Fridge 3-4 days

Reheating: microwave dal/sabzi with a splash of water 60-90s, or reheat on stove. **Don't pre-cook rice/roti for more than 1 day** — make fresh or refrigerate max 24h (reheat rice thoroughly to avoid bacteria). Chillas/parathas: make batter ahead, cook fresh in 5 min.

Prep-ahead-friendly: dal, rajma, chana masala, soya curry, sabzis, curd, boiled soya, roasted snacks.

Make fresh: rotis, chillas, poha, upma, salads.

8. Pre / Post-Workout Options & Hydration

Pre-workout (2-2:30 PM) — light, quick carbs, ≤15g protein

- 1 banana + black coffee (default — cheapest, ~₹8)
- 2 slices toast + 1 tsp jam + black coffee
- 1 banana + ½ tbsp peanut butter
- Small bowl poha (light) + black coffee

*Black coffee 20-30 min pre-gym = your free pre-workout. Keep this meal **small** (~150-250 kcal) — heavy/fatty food before a 2:30 session will make you sluggish.*

Post-workout (5-5:30 PM) — 25-35g protein + fast carbs

- Soya chunks sabzi (60g dry) + rice () (default — ~34g protein)*
- Paneer (80g) + rice bowl
- Soya pulao (soya + rice + veg)
- Big bowl curd/hung curd (200g) + banana + 30g roasted chana (*no-cook option*)
- (*If you ever get whey*) 1 scoop in milk + 1 banana — fastest, easiest 30g+

Hydration

- **Daily target: 3.5-4 L water.** Deficit + afternoon training in Mumbai heat = high sweat loss.
- **Around workout:** 500ml in the 2 hours before; sip 200-300ml every 20-30 min during; 500ml after.
- Add a **pinch of salt + lemon** to one bottle on heavy/leg days (cheap electrolytes).
- Tea: your 2 cups/day are fine — keep the 2nd one before ~5 PM so caffeine doesn't hurt sleep.

9. Substitutions & Flexibility

If you don't have / are bored of...	Swap with...
Soya chunks	Tofu, paneer, extra dal+curd combo, soya granules
Paneer	Tofu, extra soya, low-fat paneer
Toor dal	Moong, masoor, chana dal, mixed dal
Rice	Roti, jowar/bajra roti, dalia
Curd	Buttermilk, hung curd, milk
Moong chilla	Besan chilla, oats, dosa, upma
Banana (pre-workout)	Dates (2-3), small sweet potato, toast+jam
Peanut butter	Peanuts, mixed seeds, ghee (tiny amount)

- **Variety tip:** rotate the *spice/style* even if the protein is the same — soya can be bhurji, curry, pulao, keema, manchurian, tikka. Same macros, different meal.
- **Weekday vs weekend:** keep weekdays simple/prepped; use the Day-7 outside meal + cheat on whichever day you're social. Just keep it to **once/week**.

10. Supplementation Strategy (separate from ₹1,000 food budget)

You said you can't afford protein right now — that's fine, the food plan is built to work **without** it. Here's the priority order for *whenever* you have spare budget. Buy top-down.

Priority	Supplement	Why	Dose	~₹/month
1	Whey protein	Makes 140-150g protein effortless & cheaper than soya-juggling	1 scoop (~24g) post-workout or breakfast	₹600-700 (1kg)
2	Creatine monohydrate (*)	Best value muscle/strength supp; preserves strength in a deficit	5g/day, anytime with food, daily (no loading)	₹250-350
3	Multivitamin	Fills micro gaps from the deficit	1/day with breakfast	₹150-250
4	Omega-3 (fish/algal oil)	Joints + recovery + heart during hard training	1-2g EPA/DHA with a meal	₹250-350

Priority	Supplement	Why	Dose	~₹/month
5	Caffeine / pre-workout	Energy for 2:30 PM sessions	—	Use black coffee (₹5-8) instead

If budget is very tight, the honest #1 priority is actually CREATINE, not whey — because your food plan already (just barely) covers protein, but nothing in your diet replaces creatine's strength/muscle-retention benefit in a cut. ₹300 for creatine buys more than ₹300 of anything else. If you can do ₹600, get **creatine + a small whey tub**.

Monthly roll-out:

- **Month 1 (tight):** Creatine only (~₹300) + black coffee pre-workout.
- **Month 2-3:** Add 1kg whey (~₹900-1,000 total/month).
- **Month 4+:** Add multivitamin (~₹1,100-1,250/month).

Timing: Whey = post-workout or breakfast. Creatine = anytime daily with food (consistency > timing; expect +1-2 kg water weight — that's normal, not fat). Multivit = breakfast. Omega-3 = with a meal. Coffee = 20-30 min pre-gym.

Sourcing in Mumbai (avoid fakes):

- **Online (usually cheapest + most genuine):** Amazon, Flipkart, HealthKart, MuscleBlaze official store. Compare per-kg price.
- **Local:** dedicated supplement shops are fine but compare against online; many small gym shops mark up or carry fakes.
- **Spot fakes:** check the **batch number + mfg/expiry**, verify authenticity code on the brand's official site/app (HealthKart, Optimum Nutrition, MuscleBlaze all have verification), look for sealed inner foil, intact tamper seal, and consistent printing. If the price looks too good, it's fake.
- **Trusted budget brands:** MuscleBlaze, GNC, Optimum Nutrition (whey); MuscleBlaze / HealthKart / GNC creatine monohydrate (look for "Creapure" if you want the premium grade).

TRAINING PROGRAM

Your split: Chest → Back+Biceps → Shoulders+Triceps → Legs → Rest → repeat (4 training days per 5-day rolling cycle). Kept as-is because it's working for you. Session length ~75-100 min.

Two additions for your "visible abs" goal:

- **Direct ab work** added to Chest & Legs days (abs need training + low body fat).
- **Steps up to 10-12k/day** + optional short finishers. You don't do cardio and I won't force it — but since fat loss is the goal and your TDEE is your main lever, **walking is your "cardio."** Aim 10-12k steps daily; that alone burns ~150-250 extra kcal with near-zero recovery cost.

Optional 5th day (if you ever want it): *Arms + rear delts + abs + 20 min incline-walk. Purely a bonus for arm size and extra fat-loss calories. Not required.*

11. Warm-Up Protocol (5-10 min, every session)

- **General (3-4 min):** light cardio to raise temp — incline treadmill walk, cycle, or skipping.
- **Dynamic mobility (3-4 min):**
 - Arm circles + band pull-aparts ×15 (upper days)
 - Shoulder dislocates with band/towel ×10
 - Cat-cow + hip circles ×10 each
 - Leg swings front/side ×10 each + bodyweight squats ×15 (leg days)

- **Ramp-up sets:** on your first compound, do 2 light sets (~40% and ~60% of working weight) for 5–8 reps before working sets. **Never** jump straight into heavy.

12. The 4-Day Split (exercises, sets, reps, rest, RPE)

RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion (reps left in the tank). RPE 8 = 2 reps left, RPE 9 = 1 rep left, RPE 10 = failure. In a deficit, **mostly train RPE 8** on compounds, RPE 9 on isolations, save RPE 10 for last set of small muscles.

DAY A — CHEST (+ Abs)

Exercise	Sets × Reps	Rest	RPE
Flat barbell or dumbbell bench press	4 × 6–8	2–2.5 min	8
Incline dumbbell press	3 × 8–10	90 s	8
Machine chest press <i>or</i> weighted dips	3 × 8–12	90 s	9
Cable fly / pec deck	3 × 12–15	60 s	9
Cable crunch	3 × 15	45 s	9
Hanging leg raise	3 × 10–15	45 s	9

DAY B — BACK + BICEPS

Exercise	Sets × Reps	Rest	RPE
Pull-ups (assisted if needed) <i>or</i> lat pulldown	4 × 6–10	2 min	8
Barbell or dumbbell row	4 × 8–10	2 min	8
Seated cable row	3 × 10–12	90 s	9
Face pull (rear delt + shoulder health)	3 × 15	60 s	9
Barbell / EZ-bar biceps curl	3 × 8–10	75 s	9
Incline or hammer curl	3 × 10–12	60 s	9

DAY C — SHOULDERS + TRICEPS

Exercise	Sets × Reps	Rest	RPE
Overhead press (barbell or dumbbell)	4 × 6–8	2–2.5 min	8
Lateral raise	4 × 12–15	60 s	9
Reverse pec deck / rear-delt fly	3 × 15	60 s	9
Close-grip bench <i>or</i> dips (triceps)	3 × 8–10	90 s	8
Triceps rope pushdown	3 × 12–15	60 s	9
Overhead triceps extension	2 × 12–15	60 s	9

DAY D — LEGS (+ Abs)

Exercise	Sets × Reps	Rest	RPE
Barbell back squat (or goblet/leg press if no rack)	4 × 6–8	2.5–3 min	8
Romanian deadlift	3 × 8–10	2 min	8
Leg press	3 × 10–12	90 s	9

Exercise	Sets × Reps	Rest	RPE
Leg curl (hamstrings)	3 × 12-15	60 s	9
Leg extension (quads)	3 × 12-15	60 s	9
Standing calf raise	4 × 15-20	45 s	9
Weighted decline crunch	3 × 15	45 s	9

OPTIONAL DAY E — Arms + Rear Delts + Abs + LISS

Exercise	Sets × Reps
Superset: biceps curl + triceps pushdown	4 × 10-12 each
Lateral raise	4 × 15
Face pull	3 × 15
Plank	3 × 45-60 s
Cable crunch	3 × 15
Incline treadmill walk	20 min @ easy pace

13. Progressive Overload in a Deficit

In a calorie deficit your job is **mostly to MAINTAIN strength** (that's what tells your body to keep the muscle). Don't expect big PRs — flat or slightly up is a win.

- **Double progression:** pick a rep range (e.g., 6-8). Hit the top of the range on all sets → next session add the smallest weight increment (2.5kg barbell / next dumbbell). Drop back to bottom of range and build up again.
- **Track the big 4:** Bench, Row/Pulldown, Overhead Press, Squat. If these hold steady through the cut, you're keeping your muscle.
- **Reps-in-reserve check:** if a weight that was RPE 8 becomes RPE 9-10 for the same reps, that's fatigue from the deficit — hold the weight, don't force progression.
- **Realistic benchmark:** over 8-12 weeks expect to *maintain* (±5%) your main lifts and possibly add a little to smaller lifts. Newer trainees at higher body fat (you) may even gain some — bonus, not the expectation.

14. Training Intensity, Recovery & Overtraining

How hard to push while cutting:

- Compounds: hard but clean — RPE 8, leave 2 reps. Don't grind ugly reps; injury risk rises when fatigued + under-fuelled.
- Isolations: take the last set to RPE 9-10, it's safe and effective.
- **Reduce VOLUME before INTENSITY.** If you're run down, cut 1-2 sets per exercise rather than dropping the weight or skipping — this keeps the muscle-retention signal while easing recovery load.

Sleep (non-negotiable for fat loss + muscle + abs):

- **Target 7-9 h/night (aim 8).** Poor sleep raises cortisol, increases hunger, and is the #1 reason cuts stall and muscle is lost.
- Keep your 2nd tea/coffee before ~5 PM.

Active recovery (rest days): light 30-45 min walk, gentle stretching/mobility, foam rolling. Don't sit fully sedentary — it helps recovery and adds steps.

Deload: every **6-8 weeks**, or sooner if beat up — take 1 week at ~50% sets and ~10% lighter loads. You'll often come back *stronger*. This is part of the plan, not a setback.

Overtraining / under-recovery warning signs:

- Strength dropping 2+ sessions in a row
- Persistent fatigue, poor/restless sleep, elevated resting heart rate
- Constant soreness, achy joints, nagging niggles
- Low mood/irritability, no motivation to train
- Getting sick often, appetite swings (ravenous or none)

→ If you see these: take 2-3 extra rest days, bump calories to maintenance for a few days, prioritise sleep, then resume. **Pushing through these is how you lose muscle and get injured.**

Signs you're under-eating too aggressively: strength tanking, always cold, dizzy, brain fog, libido drop, fat loss stalls *despite* compliance. Fix = add ~150 kcal carbs and/or take a maintenance-calorie "diet break" week.

15. Home / Limited-Equipment Alternatives

Gym exercise	Home / bodyweight swap
Bench press	Push-ups (feet elevated for harder), floor DB press
Incline press	Pike push-ups, decline (feet up) push-ups
Lat pulldown / pull-up	Doorway rows, backpack rows, resistance-band pulldown
Barbell row	Backpack/bucket row, band row, single-arm DB row
Overhead press	Pike push-up, band/backpack overhead press
Lateral raise	Water-bottle/band lateral raise
Squat	Goblet squat (backpack), Bulgarian split squat, pistol progressions
Romanian deadlift	Single-leg RDL with backpack, band good-mornings
Leg curl	Slider/towel hamstring curl, Nordic curl negatives
Biceps/triceps	Band curls, bench/chair dips, backpack curls
Calf raise	Single-leg calf raise off a step

Load a backpack with books/water bottles for resistance. Progress by adding weight, reps, or slowing the tempo (3-4 s lowering).

16. Workout Tracking Template

Log **every** session — what gets measured gets managed. Keep it in a notebook or phone notes:

Date: _____ Day: Chest / Back+Bi / Sh+Tri / Legs
 Bodyweight (AM, fasted): _____ kg Sleep last night: _____ h
 Energy (1-5): _____

Exercise	Set1	Set2	Set3	Set4	RPE	Notes
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e.g. Bench press	60×8	60×8	60×7	60×6	8	up 2.5kg next wk
	wt × rep	wt × rep	wt × rep	wt × rep		

Session notes (pump, niggles, what to change): _____

Weekly check-ins (same day/time each week, e.g. Sunday AM):

- Bodyweight (use the 7-day average, not single readings — daily weight bounces with water/food)
- Waist measurement at navel (often moves even when scale doesn't)

- 1 progress photo (front, relaxed, same lighting)
- Main-lift loads holding? → muscle retained [YES]

17. Form Cues & Safety (key lifts)

- **Bench press:** shoulder blades pinched + down, slight arch, feet planted, bar to lower chest, elbows ~45°, full lockout. Always use a spotter or safety pins for heavy sets.
- **Row:** hinge ~45°, neutral spine (no rounding), pull to lower ribs, squeeze shoulder blades, don't yank with momentum.
- **Overhead press:** brace core + glutes, bar over mid-foot, don't lean back excessively, full lockout overhead.
- **Squat:** brace before descending, knees track over toes, hit at least parallel, drive through mid-foot, chest up. Use safety pins.
- **Romanian deadlift:** soft knees, push hips *back*, bar stays close to legs, feel the hamstring stretch, neutral spine — stop before your back rounds.
- **General:** brace your core on every heavy rep, control the lowering (don't drop the weight), full range of motion > ego weight. **A tweak from sloppy form in a deficit can derail weeks of progress.**

INTEGRATION

18. Daily Schedule Template (Training Day)

Time	Activity
6:30–7:00 AM	Wake, 300–500 ml water, weigh in (fasted), light stretch
7:00–8:00 AM	Breakfast + 1st tea/coffee + creatine (when you have it) + multivit
8:00 AM–1 PM	Work/study — sip water (aim ~1.5 L by lunch), get steps in
10:00–11:00 AM	Mid-morning snack
1:00–2:00 PM	Lunch
2:00–2:30 PM	Pre-workout (banana + black coffee) + 400 ml water
2:30–4:30 PM	GYM — warm-up → workout → cool-down (sip 200–300 ml/20 min)
4:30–5:00 PM	Walk home / cool down, 500 ml water
5:00–5:30 PM	Post-workout meal (high protein + carbs)
5:30–7:00 PM	Light activity / walk to hit step goal
7:00–8:00 PM	Dinner
8:00–10:00 PM	Relax, screens down ~30 min before bed
10:00 PM	Optional evening milk (protein before sleep)
10:30–11:00 PM	Sleep (target 7–9 h)

Rest day: drop the pre/post meals, keep protein high (add a booster), take a 30–45 min walk, sleep in a little. Use it to meal-prep.

19. Synergy Tips (how it all works together)

- **Meal timing → performance:** lunch (1–2 PM) fuels the session; the light banana + coffee pre-workout tops up quick energy without sitting heavy in your stomach during squats. Heavy/oily food before 2:30 = sluggish session — keep pre-workout light.

- **Post-workout window:** get 25–35g protein + carbs within ~45 min of finishing — this is when soya/paneer + rice does the most for recovery and muscle retention. Not magic, but a solid habit.
 - **Caffeine = free pre-workout:** black coffee 20–30 min before the gym gives you the afternoon energy lift for ₹5–8. Keep all caffeine before ~5 PM so it doesn't wreck the sleep that's driving your fat loss.
 - **Creatine + cut:** if/when you add it, take 5g daily *consistently* — timing doesn't matter. The small water-weight bump (1–2 kg) is intramuscular water (good, looks fuller), not fat.
 - **Hydration around training:** dehydration kills strength fast. Front-load water before the session, sip during, rehydrate after — especially on Mumbai-hot leg days (add salt + lemon).
 - **Steps are your fat-loss accelerator:** since you don't do cardio, the 10–12k daily steps quietly create extra deficit with zero impact on lifting recovery. This is the single easiest lever to speed up the abs timeline.
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20. Your First 30 Days — Action Checklist

- [] Hit **1,930 kcal avg / 135–145g protein** daily (lean on soya chunks)
- [] Drink **3.5–4 L water** daily
- [] Train your 4-day split, **log every session**, hold your main lifts
- [] Walk **10–12k steps/day**
- [] Sleep **7–9 h/night**
- [] Weigh in daily (fasted) — track the **7-day average**, not single days
- [] Waist + 1 photo weekly
- [] Keep cheat to **one meal/week** (Day 7)
- [] Buy **creatine** first when budget allows; whey next
- [] Re-check at week 4: if weekly-avg weight isn't down ~2–3 kg, drop ~150 kcal (½ katori rice) and add ~2k steps

Expected by July 20: ~81–82 kg, leaner waist, upper abs emerging, lifts maintained.

Abs timeline (real): ~Sept–Oct at this pace. Stay consistent — you've already proven you can (87 → 85.4). The plan just makes the next 10 kg systematic.

All values are practical estimates (±10%) for Mumbai ingredients/prices. Adjust portions to your hunger and the scale trend. This is a fitness/nutrition guide, not medical advice — if you have any health conditions, check with a doctor before starting.